OANNES
2026, 8(2) September

Research Article DOI: 10.33469/oannes.1962574

Civic Identity and Sacred Memory at the Margins of Epic Geography: Paris/Alexandros, the Adrasteia Legacy and the Representational Repertoire at Parion

Sadık TUĞRUL
Corresponding Author
Independent Researcher, Çanakkale, Türkiye
tugrulsadik17@gmail.com

Vedat KELEŞ
Author
Ondokuz Mayıs University, Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, Department of Archaeology, Samsun, Türkiye.
vkelesus@gmail.com

Submitted	02.06.2026
Revision Requested Last	28.06.2026
Revision Received	16.07.2026
Accepted Date	18.09.2026
Publication Date	27.09.2026

Cite this article
Tuğrul, S. & Keleş, V. (2026). Civic Identity and Sacred Memory at the Margins of Epic Geography: Paris/Alexandros, the Adrasteia Legacy and the Representational Repertoire at Parion, *Oannes*, 8(2), September, pp. 384-399.

The content of this journal is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-Noncommercial 4.0 International License.

Abstract

This article examines Parion's place within the epic and sacred geography of the Troad through the relationship among civic identity, sacred memory and public representation. It begins from the premise that the city's identity cannot be reduced to a single origin narrative, fixed etymology or uninterrupted cultic continuity. Its central argument is that a distinctive Parian repertoire of civic memory and representation can be reconstructed from bodies of evidence belonging to different periods and carrying unequal evidentiary weight. Colonisation and eponymic traditions, local sacred genealogy, sacred topography, public commemoration and numismatic imagery served different functions within this repertoire. Although Parion was an Archaic foundation outside the Homeric narrative, its location between the Propontis, Hellespont and Troad enabled later associations with the region's epic past. Strabo provides the principal textual basis for discussing Adrasteia, Apollo Aktaios, Artemis, the reported transfer of sanctuary material and the Altar of Hermokreon. Athenagoras' contested Alexandros passage offers a specific textual record of a taphos, bronze eikōn, sacrifice and festival in the agora, while the Paris/Alexandros identification remains a defensible but non-exclusive modern reading. The Gorgoneion, Apollo Aktaios, Eros/Cupid and Pario Conditori types document the circulation of selected images and sacred or founding references without establishing collective belief, ritual continuity or a single political programme. In the Roman period, local, sacred and epic memories were rearticulated through colonial status and imperial visual codes.

Keywords: *Parion, Troad, sacred memory, Paris/Alexandros, numismatic representation.*

Genişletilmiş Özet

Parion, Propontis'in güney kıyısında, Troas ile Hellespontos arasındaki geçiş kuşağında yer alan bir kenttir. Bronz Çağı'na bağlanan epik anlatının değil, sonraki kolonizasyon sürecinin ürünü olduğu için Homerosçu gelenekte bir odak olarak yer almaz; ancak Troas'ın epik ve kutsal bellek alanlarına yakınlığı, bu mirasla daha geç dönemlerde ilişkilendirilmesine imkân vermiştir. Çalışma, Parion kimliğinin tek bir köken anlatısına, sabit bir etimolojiye, kesintisiz kült aktarımına veya doğrudan bir Roma siyasal programına indirgenemeyeceği yöntemsel öncülünden hareket eder. Merkezî savı, adlandırma, kutsal topografya, kamusal anma, nümismatik temsil ve Roma koloni diline ilişkin farklı kanıtların Parion'a özgü bir kentsel bellek ve temsil repertuarı içinde değerlendirilebileceğidir.

Makalenin yöntemi, farklı türdeki kanıtları aynı düzeye yerleştirmemeye dayanır. Antik tanıklıklar, geç mitografik anlatılar, epigrafik ve nümismatik kayıtlar, modern topografik çalışmalar ve kuramsal literatür birbirini tamamlayan fakat aynı ağırlığa sahip olmayan veri gruplarıdır. Strabon ve Athenagoras, makalenin iki temel antik tanıklık eksenini oluşturur; Frisch'in testimonia derlemesi ise bu tanıklıkların izlenmesini sağlayan modern bir kontrol corpus'u olarak kullanılır. Bu ayrım sayesinde antik kaynak, modern yorum, katalog verisi ve kuramsal çerçeve birbirinin yerine geçirilmez. Bu yöntem, bulgu ile yorumu birbirinden ayırmayı da amaçlar.

Parion'un adlandırma ve yerel bellek gelenekleri, kolonizasyon bağlantıları, eponimik figürler, yerel kutsal soy ve Troas'ın epik geçmişi arasında farklı ilişkiler kurar. Paros, Erythrai ve Miletos çevresindeki kolonizasyon gelenekleri, Parios/Iasion eponimisi, Ophiogeneis'in yılan kökenli ve iyileştirici yerel soy belleği ve Paris/Priamos-Amandros anlatıları farklı kesinlik düzeylerine sahiptir. Bu gelenekler tarihsel kuruluş belgeleri olarak değil, Parion'un koloni geçmişi, eponimik figür, yerel kutsal soy ve Troas'ın epik belleğiyle ilişkilendirilmesini sağlayan farklı bellek unsurları olarak değerlendirilir.

Strabon'un Adrasteia, Apollon Aktaios, Artemis, kutsal alan malzemesinin Parion'a taşındığı yönündeki anlatı ve Hermokreon Sunağı'na ilişkin aktarımı, Parion'un yakın kutsal topografyayla ilişkisini tartışmanın başlıca antik metinsel dayanağıdır. Strabon daha eski ve günümüze ulaşmamış kaynaklardan yararlanmış olabilir; ancak bu pasajın kaynağı belirlenememektedir. Pasaj, bildirilen malzeme transferi ile sunağın yeni anıtsal bağlamını tartışmaya imkân verir; kehanetin sona erdiği bilgisi ise Adrasteia'daki ritüel işlevlerin Parion'da aynen sürdüğü yorumunu sınırlar. Ophiogeneis geleneği, Parion çevresindeki yerel kutsal repertuarın yalnız Adrasteia-Apollon hattından ibaret olmadığını, yılan, iyileştirme, soy ve kutsal topografya ilişkilerinin de kent belleğinde yer alabildiğini gösterir.

Athenagoras'ın Parion agorasına ilişkin tanıklığı, makalenin başlıca metinsel kayıtlarından biridir; ancak Alexandros'un kimliği tartışmalıdır. Pasaj, agorada Alexandros'a ait bir taphos, bronz eikōn, kurban ve festival bilgisini doğrudan aktarır. Schoedel'in Abonuteichuslu Alexandros yönündeki açıklaması ve Proteus/Peregrinus bağlamı dikkate alınırken, Corso ve Keleş-Yılmaz çizgisindeki Paris/Alexandros yorumu da modern literatürde savunulmuş bir okuma olarak değerlendirilir. Bu nedenle pasaj, belirli bir yapının arkeolojik teşhisi veya tüm kurumsal yapısı belgelenmiş bir kahraman kültü olarak değil, agora içindeki kamusal ve ritüel anmaya ilişkin özgül bir metinsel kayıt olarak kullanılır.

Gorgoneion ve boğa tipleri Parion'un erken kentsel tanınırlığını; Apollon Aktaios ve sunak betimleri Adrasteia ile ilişkilendirilen kutsal referansların sikke dilindeki dolaşımını; Eros/Cupid tipleri sanat belleği ve yerel kült referanslarının Roma dönemi görsel dili içinde yeniden ifade edilmesini; Pario Conditori tipi ise kurucu bellek, Parios/Parius-Paris muğlaklığı ve Roma koloni dili arasındaki ilişkiyi belgeler. Parion'un yerel kentsel ve Roma dönemindeki koloni bağlamlarında üretilip dolaşıma sokulan bu tipler, belirli imgeler ile kutsal veya kurucu referansların kamusal temsilini gösterir; ancak ortak inancı, ritüel sürekliliğini veya tekil bir siyasal programı tek başlarına kanıtlamaz.

Roma dönemi, Parion kimliğini sıfırdan icat eden bir evre değil, yerel, kutsal ve epik bellek unsurlarının koloni dili ve imparatorluk görsel kodları içinde yeniden dolaşıma girdiği tarihsel bağlamdır. Bu çerçevede Parion, epik anlatının dışında kurulmuş bir kentte kutsal miras, yerel soy anlatıları, agora belleği, sanat ve kült referanslarının Roma dönemi temsil dili içinde birlikte görünür olabildiği bir örnek sunar. Bu yönüyle makale, kentsel kimliğin geçmişe ilişkin unsurların mekân, anıt, ritüel ve dolaşımdaki imgeler aracılığıyla yeniden düzenlenmesiyle şekillendiğini savunur.

Bu çerçevede makalenin katkısı, epik coğrafyanın sınırında kalan Parion'un farklı dönemlere ait bellek unsurlarının hangi kanıt türleri aracılığıyla kamusal ve kentsel bir repertuar içinde anlam kazandığını açıklamaktır. Kolonizasyon gelenekleri, yerel kutsal-soy anlatıları, Adrasteia ile ilişkilendirilen kutsal miras, agorada yoğunlaşan kamusal anma ve Roma dönemi sikke imgeleri aynı tarihsel ağırlıkta değildir. Yazılı tanıklıklar, geç mitografik aktarımlar, topografik değerlendirmeler ve nümismatik imgeler aynı tarihsel gerçekliğin doğrudan belgeleri olarak değil, Parion'un kentsel belleğini farklı düzeylerde izlemeyi sağlayan kanıt grupları olarak kullanılır. Bu yaklaşım, kesinleştirilemeyen iddiaları sınırlandırırken kentin kimliğini mekânsal, ritüel ve görsel pratikler üzerinden tartışılabilir kılar. Parion örneği böylece kentsel kimliğin farklı dönemlere ait bellek unsurlarının mekân, anıt, ritüel ve dolaşımdaki imgeler içinde seçici biçimde yeniden bağlamlandırılmasıyla şekillendiğini ortaya koyar.

Introduction: Problem, Method and Sources

Parion is a harbour city on the southern Propontic coast, within the transitional belt between the Troad and the Hellespont. Ancient and modern literature locate it variously within the Troad, Mysia, the

Hellespontine region and, in the modern inventory of poleis, on the Asian coast of the Propontis (Cook, 1973; Avram, 2004, pp. 991-992). This plurality requires Parion to be assessed at the margins between the Troad's epic geography and the Propontic-Hellespontine region, rather than within a single regional category.

That Parion does not figure as a focus comparable to Ilion in the Homeric epic narrative is chronologically to be expected: the city is not a component of the Bronze Age epic world of the Troad, but belongs instead to the later Archaic colonisation process. The link between Parion and the epic memory of the Troad must therefore be discussed not as a continuity of origin but through the selective relations the city established with this heritage in later periods. From this the central question of the study arises: although Parion was not a natural part of the epic narrative, through which naming traditions, transfers of sacred heritage, public commemorative practices and instruments of numismatic representation can it be associated with the epic and sacred geography of the Troad?

This study begins from the premise that Parion's identity cannot be reduced to a single origin narrative, a fixed Paris etymology or a linear cultic continuity. Its central argument is that a distinctive Parian repertoire of civic memory and representation can be reconstructed from colonisation and eponymic traditions, local sacred genealogies, sacred topography, public commemoration and circulating numismatic imagery. Evidence for these components comes from sources of different dates and types, not all carrying equal evidentiary weight. Miletos, too, is treated cautiously as one element within Parion's multiple colonisation traditions rather than as a definite founding centre (Keleş, 2011, pp. 238-239).

Strabo's account of the cults of Adrasteia, Apollo Aktaios and Artemis, the reported transfer of sanctuary material to Parion and the Altar of Hermokreon provides the principal ancient textual basis for discussing the city's relationship with its nearby sacred environment (Strab. 13.1.13 = Frisch, 1983, p. 90, no. T102a). This passage allows discussion of the material and monumental recontextualisation of sacred heritage at Parion; but, because it states that the oracle had ceased, it does not show that the ritual functions at Adrasteia continued unchanged at Parion. Athenagoras' reference to a *taphos* belonging to Alexandros, a bronze *eikōn*, public sacrifices and a festival in the agora of Parion offers a specific textual record of public and ritual commemoration in the city centre (Ath. Leg. 26.3-5; Athenagoras, 1972, pp. 65-66 = Frisch, 1983, p. 58, no. T41). Yet, since the identity of Alexandros is contested, the Paris/Alexandros interpretation should be treated not as a necessary consequence of the passage but as a defensible, though non-exclusive, reading in modern scholarship. Frisch's work, in turn, functions as a modern control *corpus* for tracing the ancient and late antique *testimonia*; Frisch's reference numbers are used only to make the attestations traceable and are not treated as substitutes for the ancient texts themselves.

The same hierarchy applies to late mythographic narratives, numismatic evidence and theoretical literature. Late antique and Byzantine narratives are evidence not for Parion's Archaic foundation but for the later transmission and reformulation of traditions linking Paris/Priamos with the city. Coins struck at Parion, by contrast, belong to local civic or colonial contexts of production and circulation and show which images, legends and sacred or founding references entered public representation, without directly documenting collective belief, ritual practice or cultic continuity. Numismatic types, legends and iconographic details are interpreted only when verified from identifiable specimens or reliable catalogues and corpora.

The theoretical framework does not substitute for the ancient sources and the numismatic data; it provides only a limited interpretative language for explaining how different bodies of evidence may operate together. Assmann is useful here chiefly because he treats monuments, tombs, temples and images as media through which time and identity can be materially anchored (Assmann, 2011, pp. 7-8). Alcock brings this question closer to archaeological space through her use of *lieux de mémoire* in relation to monuments, sanctuaries, cemeteries and festivals (Alcock, 2002, p. 21). Nora is used more narrowly, as a comparative caution that memory may concentrate in particular places and objects, not as a model of modern national memory transferred to the ancient city (Nora, 1989, p. 7). Within this framework the expression "memory repertoire" in the article designates the instruments of naming, sacred-topographical reference, public commemoration and numismatic representation to which Parion could turn in different periods.

The article proceeds by this logic of evidence. The next section treats Parion's naming, eponymic and local sacred-genealogical traditions in the context of civic memory; the sections that follow discuss the Adrasteia-Apollo Aktaios-Hermokreon axis, Athenagoras' agora testimony, the numismatic data and the Roman-period colonial language as different layers of evidence of the same model. This sequence avoids two misleading alternatives: treating Parion as a rival epic centre to Ilion, or reducing it to a local colonial city.

Parion in Epic Geography: Naming Traditions and Civic Memory

Parion's relationship with the epic geography of the Troad must be treated on a different plane from the example of Ilion at the focus of the Iliad. Founded in the Archaic period, the city is not a natural part of the epic narrative bound to the Bronze Age; its link with the memory of the Troad can therefore be discussed not directly through a continuity of origin but through the layers of naming, descent, local sacred tradition and epic association operating in later periods. The aim of this section is not to determine the ultimate philological origin of the name Parion but to show what functions the relationships among the colonisation traditions surrounding Paros/Erythrai/Miletos, the Parios/Iasion eponymy, the Ophiogeneis tradition and the Paris/Priamos-Amandros narratives carried within civic memory.

The ancient traditions concerning the foundation of Parion do not converge around a single metropolis narrative. Frisch records Erythrai, Thasos, Paros and a Miletos-Erythrai-Paros partnership in different forms, while regarding the association with Paros as the more natural explanation (Frisch, 1983, pp. 59-60, no. T43-47a). Keleş likewise notes Erythrai, Paros and Miletos, but stresses that the Miletos connection lacks archaeological confirmation (Keleş, 2011, pp. 238-239). Özmen shows that modern scholars have interpreted the roles of Paros, Erythrai, Miletos and Thasos differently (Özmen, 2024, p. 169). This plurality is better read as a field of memory linking Parion's past to different Aegean and Propontic connections. Malkin's network approach helps explain why such multiple origin narratives need not be treated as confused traditions, but as relational ways in which poleis constructed the past (Malkin, 2011, pp. 8-9).

The second layer of naming memory is formed by the eponymous founder Parios or Parius. In the records arranged by Frisch under T31-33, Parios/Parius explains the name Parion and is linked to the lineage of Iasion (Frisch, 1983, p. 56, no. T31-33). These records are not documents of historical foundation, but eponymic memory elements that bind the city's name to a mythological genealogy. They do not identify Parios/Parius with Paris/Alexandros; rather, they place him within the Iasion lineage. Curty's work on legendary kinship shows how mythological heroes or gods could provide cities with a language of relational past and legitimacy rather than proof of historical origin (Curty, 1999, pp. 167, 184). In this sense the Parios/Iasion eponymy functions as a memory mechanism linking Parion to a wider field of mythological descent and founder figures.

Parion's local sacred memory is not limited to the Parios/Iasion eponymy. Strabo's immediately following testimony reports that at Parion a *genos* called the Ophiogeneis claimed kinship with snakes and was associated with a healing power against snakebites; the same record states that the *arkhēgetēs* of the *genos* was recounted as a *heros* transformed from a snake (Strab. 13.1.14 = Frisch, 1983, p. 93, no. T107c). The other attestations Frisch collects likewise show the Ophiogeneis as a local descent tradition around Parion to which a snake origin and a healing power were attributed; the Aelianus tradition, for its part, transmits the narrative of Halia's union with a sacred snake in the grove of Artemis (Frisch, 1983, pp. 93-94, no. T107a-e). This tradition is not directly connected with the Paris/Alexandros memory; but it points to a local memory layer operating among the languages of descent, sacred power, healing and *heros* at Parion. The Ophiogeneis thus shows that Parion's repertoire of the past did not consist solely of colonial or epic connections, and that local sacred-genealogical traditions too could hold a place within civic memory.

The Paris/Priamos-Amandros tradition, for its part, forms a later but striking layer in the association of Parion with the epic geography of the Troad. In the late antique and Byzantine attestations Frisch collects under T36-40, Priamos, on the prophecy that Paris would drive Troy to ruin, sends him to a distant territory known by the name Amandra, Amandros or Mandro; in some variants he founds Parion there for Paris. These narratives are not evidence of an early historical foundation; they are used here as late mythographic transmissions preserved through Frisch's arrangement of the Parion testimonia. The more secure interpretation is to assess the Paris/Priamos-Amandros tradition as a mythographic transmission showing that Parion could be associated with the Paris/Alexandros memory in the late antique and Byzantine periods

(Frisch, 1983, pp. 57-58, no. T36-40). The variants Amandra/Amandros/Mandro too are treated not as a definite former name of Parion but as a toponymic tradition that locates the Paris narrative in the environs of Parion.

At this point the interpretative value and the etymological evidential value of the phonetic proximity among the names Parion, Parios, Paros and Paris are kept distinct from one another. The phonetic proximity may have created a ground favourable for ancient and late antique authors to construct mythological connections; but on its own it does not show that the name Parion derives from Paris. This proximity is, by contrast, important for understanding why Parion's naming memory could be associated with different founder figures, genealogical narratives and epic connections. Instead of the proposition "the name Parion comes from Paris", it can therefore be said that the figure Paris/Alexandros is an epic element incorporated into Parion's later naming memory and civic-identity discourse.

The Roman-period *Pario Conditori* type shows that this memory of naming and founder figure continued in the subsequent field of numismatic representation. Frisch's record T34 transmits a youthful male head and the legend Pario condit(ori) among the Parion attestations (Frisch, 1983, p. 56, no. T34). Since, however, the catalogue, legend and iconographic variants of this type require numismatic verification, the detailed assessment is taken up in the fifth section. What matters here is to note that the Parius/Paris ambiguity is not entirely closed in the Roman-period visual idiom either, and that it adds a new visual dimension to the discussion of foundational memory. In this section the *Pario Conditori* type functions not for iconographic identification but as a bridge showing that the eponymic and epic naming memory could intersect with the Roman colonial idiom; the consequences for interpretation that follow from defining the figure as Paris or as Parius are taken up in the fifth section, within the framework of the problem of numismatic representation and foundational memory.

Parion's naming and local memory traditions therefore operate on four planes: colonisation narratives connect the city to Aegean and Propontic networks; the Parios/Iasion eponymy frames the name through founder-genealogy; the Ophiogeneis tradition adds a local sacred-genealogical layer; and the Paris/Priamos-Amandros narrative attaches Parion to the epic memory of the Troad in later transmission. Athenagoras' account offers a more specific textual record of public commemoration by referring to a *taphos*, bronze *eikōn*, sacrifice and festival for Alexandros in the agora (Ath. Leg. 26.3-5 = Frisch, 1983, p. 58, no. T41). Together, these strands outline Parion's differentiated memory repertoire and prepare the discussion of the Adrasteia-Apollo Aktaios-Hermokreon axis.

From Adrasteia to Parion: Apollo Aktaios, the Altar of Hermokreon and the Sacred Landscape

Parion's relationship with the epic and sacred geography of the Troad cannot be explained solely through naming traditions or the Paris/Alexandros memory. Adrasteia, in the city's nearby sacred environment, emerges through Strabo's testimony as an important religious and spatial focus associated with Apollo Aktaios, Artemis and an oracle within the wider Propontic cultic context surveyed by Erpehlivan (2019, pp. 39-40). In this section the term "sacred landscape" is used not in the sense of a broad landscape theory but in the sense of a limited field of relations traceable among Adrasteia, Priapos and Parion through ancient attestations and modern localisation proposals (Fig. 1). This usage is consistent with the *polis* literature that stresses that sanctuaries could function not only as places of ritual practice but also as foci related to communal belonging, the perception of space and territorial order. De Polignac's approach to the function of sanctuaries in ordering space and enabling the community to recognise itself within a particular territorial framework provides a limited theoretical support for assessing the Adrasteia legacy to the extent that Strabo's testimony permits (de Polignac, 1995, pp. 19-20). This framework is not used as a substitute for the ancient evidence; it only helps to explain why the Adrasteia material could become meaningful at Parion in terms of civic memory.

The main source for this discussion is Strabo. He may have drawn on earlier sources now lost or unidentified, but the source of this passage cannot be established. Strabo reports that Adrasteia lay between Priapos and Parion and that below it there was a plain of the same name. In the same passage he speaks of an oracle of Apollo Aktaios and Artemis in this plain; he then relates that, upon the destruction of the

sanctuary, its equipment and its stone and architectural material were transported to Parion, where an altar, the work of Hermokreon and notable for its size and beauty, was built. The decisive interpretative limit of the passage is that the oracle is explicitly said to have ceased, as at Zeleia (Strab. 13.1.13 = Frisch, 1983, p. 90, no. T102a). The passage therefore points not to the unchanged continuation of Adrasteia's ritual functions at Parion, but to the transport of sanctuary material into a new monumental context.

The movement from Adrasteia to Parion is better understood as the recontextualisation of sanctuary material and its associated memory, rather than as a complete transfer of cult. Schreyer's reading of Strabo is important here: apart from Strabo there is no direct attestation of the transfer, and the continuation of the oracular function at Parion remains uncertain (Schreyer, 2023, p. 88). Schreyer therefore shifts attention from abstract cultic continuity to concrete objects, especially sanctuary equipment and marble or architectural material (Schreyer, 2023, pp. 88-89). For Parion, the central point is the reinterpretation of Adrasteia's sacred heritage in the context of a new monumental altar whose oracular function cannot be shown to have continued.

Strabo's Ophiogeneis testimony reports that at Parion there was in circulation a tradition of a *genos*, a local kin group, claiming kinship with snakes and associated with a healing power (Strab. 13.1.14 = Frisch, 1983, p. 93, no. T107c). Frisch's Aelianus record, for its part, transmits the narrative of Halia's union with a sacred snake in the grove of Artemis as another variant of this tradition (Frisch, 1983, p. 94, no. T107e). This evidence cannot be included in the same transfer process as the oracular precinct of Apollo Aktaios and Artemis at Adrasteia; but it shows that around Parion the memory of Artemis, snake, healing power and local descent too could join the city's sacred past. The Ophiogeneis is therefore best assessed here not as the carrier of the main discussion but as a local sacred-genealogical layer that complements the Adrasteia-Apollo axis.

Although the precise localisation of Adrasteia is disputed, ancient attestations and modern topographical assessments suggest that it was not a distant mythological reference for Parion. Frisch's Strabo testimony places Adrasteia between Priapos and Parion, near the plain of the same name; following Leaf, it has been sought around Örtülüce, about 12 km south-east of Kemer (Leaf, 1923, pp. 77-78; Frisch, 1983, pp. 50-51, no. T15). Körpe places the discussion between Kocagür and Örtülüce, while Özmen stresses the hot springs, spolia and archaeological density around Örtülüce (Körpe, 2014, p. 8; Özmen, 2024, pp. 154-155). This evidence provides a sufficient topographical basis for discussing Adrasteia's relationship with Parion, although the settlement's precise position and limits remain uncertain.

In Strabo's account, the Altar of Hermokreon is the most prominent monumental element of the Adrasteia legacy at Parion. Keleş stresses that Strabo is the only ancient source for the altar: after the destruction of the sanctuary at Adrasteia, its objects and architectural components were transported to Parion, where a large altar was remembered as the work of Hermokreon (Keleş, 2018, p. 24). This suggests that the Adrasteia heritage was not simply reused as material, but transformed into a memorable element of Parion's public and monumental memory. The problems Keleş identifies remain open: Hermokreon's identity, the altar's form and plan, and the relation between the monument and altar depictions on Parian coins cannot be determined securely (Keleş, 2018, pp. 24-25).

Hermokreon's status must also remain open. Strabo names Hermokreon but gives no detail about his identity. Keleş notes that modern sources have understood him as an architect and sculptor under Eumenes II; this is modern interpretation, not direct Strabonian information (Keleş, 2018, p. 25). He is therefore not defined here as architect, priest, dedicant or benefactor. What matters is that the altar entered ancient memory through Hermokreon's name, indicating a link between individual name, monumental production and civic memory.

The scale and visual impact of the altar must also be treated cautiously. Strabo's reference to its size and beauty indicates a prestigious monumental focus rather than ordinary spolia or simple reuse. Keleş notes modern comparisons with the Altar of Zeus at Pergamon and the Altar of Hieron II at Syracuse, but the argument here rests not on restitution or scale, but on the transformation of the Adrasteia legacy into a memorable civic object at Parion (Keleş, 2018, p. 24).

Strabo associates Apollo Aktaios primarily with the oracular precinct at Adrasteia; this evidence indicates that the god formed an important point of reference in Parion's nearby sacred environment (Strab. 13.1.13). Ful, noting that the cult epithet "Aktaios" of Apollo has the semantic field of "situated on/by the coast", stresses that in the Parian context it may be the oracular aspect of Apollo rather than any clear maritime function that comes to the fore (Ful, 2021, pp. 165-166). This interpretation is consistent with Strabo's association of Apollo Aktaios with the oracular hearth at Adrasteia; but the meaning of this cult epithet does not on its own prove that the oracular function at Adrasteia continued at Parion. By contrast, Parian coins with the Apollo Aktaios legend form a supporting body of data showing that this sacred reference could enter the city's visual and numismatic representational repertoire (Frisch, 1983, pp. 89-90, no. T101). This coin evidence is noted here only with respect to the entry of the sacred reference into the public visual field; the detailed iconographic and catalogue assessment is made in the fifth section.

The Adrasteia-Apollo Aktaios-Hermokreon axis is important less for Parion's passive inheritance of the sacred past in its environs than for its repositioning of that past within civic memory and monumental representation. Strabo is the sole surviving ancient source to state that sanctuary material was transferred to Parion and the Altar of Hermokreon constructed there; his notice that the oracle had ceased limits interpreting this sequence as functional cultic continuity. The Ophiogeneis tradition, in the same regional context but through a tradition distinct from the cult material at Adrasteia, is added to the city's local sacred-genealogical memory. In this respect the section shows that Parion made the sacred and local memory elements in its immediate environs legible again within its own civic context, and it prepares the spatial-mnemonic ground for the transition to Athenagoras' agora testimony.

Paris/Alexandros in the Agora of Parion: *Taphos*, Bronze *Eikōn* and Ritual Memory

While the Adrasteia-Apollo Aktaios-Hermokreon axis clarifies Parion's relationship with its nearby sacred environment, the next body of evidence directs attention to the agora. The aim here is not to prove Paris' historical presence at Parion, but to discuss how a figure called Alexandros could be incorporated into civic memory through public space, image and ritual. The explicit mention of the agora matters because, in the Hellenistic and Roman periods, it remained a representational field where statues, monuments and public events were embedded in civic life (Dickenson, 2017, pp. 42-43). In Parion, the agora provides the spatial ground for discussing the figure's public visibility and ritual accessibility.

Athenagoras reports that at Parion Alexandros had a *taphos* and a bronze *eikōn* in the agora, and that public sacrifices and festivals were held for him (Ath. Leg. 26.3-5 = Frisch, 1983, p. 58, no. T41). The terms *taphos* and *eikōn* are used here semantically, not archaeologically: the former may denote a tomb or commemorative focus, while the latter denotes an image or representation, probably a bronze statue or monumental image in this context. The evidence does not show whether the *taphos* was an actual burial, a symbolic tomb, a cenotaph or a heroic commemorative structure, nor does it allow the *eikōn* to be identified with a specific statue type. The first interpretative issue concerns Alexandros' identity. Schoedel explains him as Alexander of Abonouteichos, whereas the Homeric use of Alexandros for Paris, Frisch's inclusion of T41, Corso's Alexander Paris reading and Keleş and Yılmaz's discussion of the Paris monument/statue make the Paris/Alexandros interpretation defensible, though non-exclusive (Athenagoras, 1972, pp. 65-66; Corso, 2020, pp. 356-357; Keleş & Yılmaz, 2021, pp. 382-384).

Athenagoras' testimony offers a more specific textual account of public commemoration than the Paris/Priamos-Amandros tradition treated in the second section. While the late antique and Byzantine narratives associate Paris with the environs of Parion at a mythographic and toponymic level, Athenagoras records a *taphos* in the agora, a bronze *eikōn*, and public sacrifices and festivals organised around Alexandros.

The generic context of this testimony must be kept in view. The *Legatio* discusses pagan images, cult practices and demonological explanations within a Christian apologetic framework, so it cannot be read as a neutral archaeological report. Yet this does not remove the value of the Parion notice. Schoedel notes that Athenagoras uses mythological and religious material for apologetic purposes, while his art-historical information can generally be regarded as reliable (Athenagoras, 1972, pp. xix-xx). Marcovich places the

Legatio around AD 177 (Athenagoras, 1990, p. 1). The passage therefore reflects a local public memory recognisable enough to be used polemically in the late second century, although its route of transmission remains uncertain.

The expression *taphos* lies at the centre of this local memory information. The term at first sight carries the meaning "tomb"; but the present state of the evidence does not confirm that a physical burial belonging to the figure of Alexandros was found at Parion. Even if the Paris/Alexandros interpretation is adopted, the more secure reading is to assess the *taphos* as a symbolic tomb, cenotaph, heroic commemorative structure or focus of public memory located in the agora. Ekroth's study of hero cults provides no direct Parion evidence here; but it offers a comparative ground showing that heroic commemorative practices in the Greek world were not always limited to an actual burial. Ekroth stresses that in hero cults the tomb could be important but that the cult focus could in some cases be constructed through a tomb, a cenotaph or other remains and objects associated with the hero (Ekroth, 2002, pp. 337-338). Jones's assessment of the forms of commemoration shaped around local heroes, the *arkhēgetēs* and healing/protective qualities likewise produces no direct evidence for Parion; but it helps to explain how the *taphos* could operate as a ritual and monumental focus of local public memory without being reduced to an actual burial (Jones, 2010, pp. 20-21).

Athenagoras' information about sacrifice and festival shows that this memory did not remain only at the monumental and visual level. Sacrifice and festival reveal that the figure of Alexandros was remembered through particular public practices in the agora of Parion and made accessible to the city community. This evidence is strong in respect of the ritual dimension; but, since no priestly institution, *temenos* boundary, inscribed cult regulation, cult calendar or institutional cult personnel is transmitted, it is not sufficient to define a fully institutional hero cult. More cautiously, if the Paris/Alexandros interpretation is adopted, the figure of Alexandros may be understood as a public and ritual focus of heroic commemoration in the agora of Parion. Ekroth's assessment of sacrificial terminology likewise shows that hero-cult rituals cannot be reduced to a uniform model; for this reason Athenagoras' information about sacrifice is strong testimony of ritual practice but does not determine the detailed form of the ritual (Ekroth, 2002, pp. 94-96, 337-338).

The bronze *eikōn* forms the visual and monumental dimension of this memory arrangement. Athenagoras states that the image was of bronze; but he does not give its artist. The bronze *eikōn* at Parion and the Alexander Paris statue Pliny attributes to Euphranor are therefore not at the same level of evidence. Pliny speaks of Euphranor's Alexander Paris statue and reports that this work was praised because it reflected at once Paris' three aspects, namely his being the judge of the goddesses, the lover of Helen and the slayer of Achilles (Plin. HN 34.77). Palagia stresses that Pliny does not state the location of the Paris statue and that the statue may be known only through an epigram (Palagia, 1980, p. 32). In the modern literature Corso constructs a probabilistic connection between these two data, while Keleş and Yılmaz too discuss Athenagoras' information about the *taphos* and bronze *eikōn* attributed to Paris at Parion together with Pliny's Euphranor statue; but both assessments rest not on a definite identity constructed directly by the ancient sources but on cautious art-historical interpretation (Corso, 2020, pp. 356-357, 360; Keleş & Yılmaz, 2021, pp. 382-384). The Euphranor connection should therefore remain a limited art-historical comparison, not a secure identification of the bronze image at Parion. Its value lies in showing that Paris/Alexandros could be conceived as a figure capable of complex monumental representation.

Since Athenagoras' passage cannot be linked securely to a particular excavated structure, podium or monumental arrangement, it should be assessed as textual evidence for commemoration and representation in the agora rather than as the archaeological identification of a specific monument. Although the identity of the figure remains contested, the passage shows that the elements of *taphos*, bronze *eikōn*, sacrifice and festival were brought together in the same public context. Within the passage, this conjunction presents Alexandros as a focus of civic memory articulated through space, image and ritual; the institutional scope of the ritual and any archaeological correlate of the monumental arrangement nevertheless remain uncertain.

Civic Identity through the Coinage: Gorgon, Apollo Aktaios, Eros and *Pario Conditori*

Coins struck at Parion belong to local civic and, in the Roman period, colonial contexts of production and public circulation, unlike the largely external literary testimonies used in this study. Their types and legends therefore document the circulation of particular images, names and sacred or founding references in this

public medium, but cannot by themselves establish shared belief, ritual practice, definite cultic continuity or a single political programme. The Testimonia section in Frisch's corpus *Die Inschriften von Parion* is a modern control compilation that brings together the ancient attestations concerning Parion and certain numismatic references; for this reason it is used here not as an independent coin catalogue but as a limited reference point that aids in tracing the relevant records. Accordingly, the analysis concentrates on the representational functions of verified types, legends and iconographic details rather than attempting a comprehensive catalogue of obverse and reverse variants.

In this section the hierarchy of evidence is preserved at three levels. At the first level are the types coming from the Parion excavations or directly discussed in the Parion literature. At the second level Frisch's testimonia records aid in tracing the ancient and modern attestations. At the third level, standard numismatic catalogues and databases, including BMC, SNG and RPC Online, are used only as reference tools for typological details and variants, not as independent evidence for ritual or civic practice (Wroth, 1892; Kraft, 1957; RPC Online, n.d.). This hierarchy makes it possible to discuss the function of the images within Parion's field of public representation, within the limits of the evidence, rather than deriving ritual practice from coin imagery.

On the early Parian coins the Gorgoneion and bull iconography is a fundamental starting point for the city's visual recognisability. Keleş states that on Parion's early coins, dated to around 500 BC, there is a Gorgon head on the obverse and an incuse on the reverse; that this repertoire continued in the fifth-century examples; and that in the fourth-century examples the Gorgoneion was paired with a bull turning its head back (Keleş, 2011, pp. 238-240). These early issues gave Parion a recognisable civic image. Here the Gorgoneion is assessed as a recognisable and protective image entering circulation together with the city's name; it is not seen as direct evidence of a particular mythological narrative.

The association of the Gorgoneion types with the Ophiogeneis tradition around Parion can be kept only at a limited level of interpretation. Strabo's testimony and the records Frisch compiles show the existence, near Parion, of the Ophiogeneis tradition that claimed kinship with snakes and was associated with a healing power (Strab. 13.1.14 = Frisch, 1983, p. 93, no. T107c). By contrast, there is no explicit ancient attestation constructing a direct connection between this tradition and the early Gorgoneion coins. The Gorgoneion should be assessed here not as a direct indicator of a local serpent-genealogical narrative but as the adaptation, to Parion's civic representational language, of a recognisable and apotropaic image in circulation in the early numismatic repertoire. It is safer to read the Gorgoneion and bull types as establishing a strong form of civic recognisability in Parion's early coinage (Fig. 2a–b).

Apollo Aktaios and altar depictions make it possible to discuss Parion's coin repertoire in the context of the sacred heritage associated with Adrasteia. Frisch's record T101 transmits a tetradrachm type with a head of Demeter on the obverse and, on the reverse, Apollo depicted between a burning altar and an *omphalos*, bearing the Apollo Aktaios legend (Frisch, 1983, pp. 89-90, no. T101; Fig. 2c–d). As noted above, Ful argues that in the Parian context the epithet Aktaios may foreground the oracular rather than a clearly maritime aspect of Apollo; the combination of *omphalos* and altar is among the iconographic elements supporting this interpretation (Ful, 2021, pp. 165-166). Considered together with Strabo's testimony concerning the oracular precinct of Apollo Aktaios and Artemis at Adrasteia, this evidence shows that sacred references connected with Adrasteia could be carried into Parion's coinage repertoire. These coins, however, do not prove that the oracular function at Adrasteia continued unchanged at Parion; they show only that the sacred reference in question could enter the field of numismatic representation. The Apollo Aktaios types may therefore be situated within a broader regional setting of sacred representation. This contextual reading, however, should not be taken as evidence for a deliberate response to the iconography of Athena Ilias.

The altar depictions must be treated within the same limited framework. In the surviving ancient record, the transport of sanctuary material from Adrasteia to Parion and the construction there of a large-scale altar are reported in Strabo's account alone (Strab. 13.1.13 = Frisch, 1983, p. 90, no. T102a). By contrast, it is not secure to identify every altar depiction on Parian coins directly with the Altar of Hermokreon. Keleş notes that in the context of the Altar of Hermokreon problems remain open such as the identity of Hermokreon, the form and plan of the altar, and whether the altar depictions on Parian coins can be associated with this

monument (Keleş, 2018, pp. 24-25). Coins with altar depictions should therefore be used not for a definite architectural restitution of the Altar of Hermokreon but to show that the sacred and monumental memory connected with Adrasteia could be reflected in Parion's coinage repertoire.

In the Roman period the Eros/Cupid types represent a different field of memory in Parion's coin repertoire. Frisch groups the Parion Eros tradition under T105, bringing together the ancient literary testimonia and the relevant numismatic evidence; in the same context, on a coin of Commodus based on the record in SNG Deutschland/Sammlung von Aulock, he transmits that on the reverse a large winged nude Eros is depicted together with a small Herme and that the legend is *Deo Cupidini* (Frisch, 1983, p. 92, no. T105c). Since this detail requires independent catalogue verification, it is used here only in respect of the presence of the Eros/Cupid image in Parion's Roman-period numismatic language. Keleş and Yılmaz likewise discuss the Praxitelean Eros tradition at Parion through ancient literary testimony and pseudo-autonomous coins; they note that on these coins the *Deo Cupidini* legend rearticulates Eros' artistic and sacred position in civic memory within the Roman-period visual language (Keleş & Yılmaz, 2021, pp. 383-384).

Kızılyalçın Oyarçin's study of the Roman provincial coins found in the Parion excavations offers a limited but important example of this tradition among the excavation finds. On the single Eros-depicting example, dating to the reign of Severus Alexander, there is on the obverse a laureate bust of the emperor with gorgoneion armour, and on the reverse a standing, winged Eros, a Herme at the lower left, and the legend DEO CVPIDINI C G I A PAR (Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, 2023, pp. 205-206, Cat. No. 241, Pl. No. 25/241; Fig. 3a–b). These types are not direct evidence of a Paris/Alexandros cult; they show rather the relationship Parion constructed among its artistic prestige, its local Eros memory and the Roman-period visual language. It can be taken into account that the Cupid figure had wide associations in the Roman world with the genealogical narrative of Venus and Aeneas; but the *Deo Cupidini* type at Parion should not be read as a local reflection of the Julio-Claudian dynasty or of an Augustan-period propaganda programme. The firmer interpretation is that Parion placed its own Eros tradition back into circulation within the Roman-period coinage repertoire.

The *Pario Conditori* type is the numismatic problem that requires the most careful treatment in the section. Frisch's record T34 transmits, on the basis of BMC Mysia no. 83, a youthful male head and the legend Pario condit(ori) among Parion's founder-figure attestations (Frisch, 1983, p. 56, no. T34). A Parion excavation specimen provides a related obverse, with a left-facing youthful male head and the legend PARIO CONDIT, paired with a reverse showing the she-wolf and twins (Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, 2023, p. 325, Cat. No. 102, Pl. No. 11/102; Fig. 3c–d). This record is important because it suggests that the Parios/Parius and Paris/Alexandros associations were not entirely closed in the Roman-period public visual field. Nevertheless, the present source verification is not sufficient to fix the figure definitively as Paris or as Parius. For this reason the type can be assessed less as a claim of iconographic identification than in respect of the relationship between foundational memory and the Roman colonial language. The Parios/Iasion tradition opens onto local eponymic founder memory, the Paris/Alexandros association onto the epic memory of the Troad, and the *conditor* language onto Roman-period founder and colonial discourse. This flexibility shows that Parion could place its founder-figure memory into circulation among different fields of meaning without reducing it to a single identity.

At this point the interpretative consequence of the iconographic identification is important: if the figure is read as Paris, the type makes Parion's late mythographic Paris/Alexandros memory visible within Roman-period language of foundation figures; if it is read as Parius/Parios, it points instead to the re-expression of a local eponymous foundation tradition through colonial coinage. Since the present catalogue and publication evidence is not sufficient to identify the figure securely with either option, the type is better understood as a representational field in which foundational memory remained open to more than one reading within Roman colonial titulature.

Taken together, Parion's numismatic repertoire is significant less as a series of isolated documents than as a set of visual choices made in different periods. The Gorgoneion and bull types gave the city an early and recognisable civic image; the Apollo Aktaios and altar types brought Adrasteia-related sacred references into the coinage repertoire; the Eros/Cupid types rearticulated local artistic and cultic memory in a Roman visual idiom; and the *Pario Conditori* type kept foundation memory open between the Parios/Parius-Paris ambiguity and Roman colonial vocabulary. Through coinage, Parion gave durable and circulating form to

several strands of its remembered past: epic association, sacred reference, artistic prestige and colonial status.

Parion between Troy and Rome: Local Memory, Empire and the Strategy of Identity

The Roman period did not erase the earlier layers of local memory traced above; it altered the idiom through which they could be expressed. Colonial status, Latin legends, founder-figure images and imperial visual codes provided a new field of public representation for Parion's naming traditions, the Adrasteia legacy, the agora memory and the numismatic repertoire. In this context the expression "colonial language" designates not a centrally planned, integral propaganda programme but Parion's ability, in the Roman period, to express its status, local memory and elements of civic representation through Latin legends, colonial abbreviations and selected images.

In the Roman world the Trojan past was associated in particular, around Aeneas, Venus, the Julii and Ilion, with the production of founding descent, legitimacy and political image. Erskine stresses the founding role of the Aeneas, Lavinium, Alba Longa and Romulus-Remus line in Rome's Trojan-origin narrative, and the symbolic weight the Trojan past acquired for Roman identity in the periods of Caesar and Augustus (Erskine, 2001, pp. 15-19, 225-245). Gruen's assessment of Rome's Trojan connection, before the late Republic, as a way of positioning itself within the shared cultural world of the eastern Mediterranean on the basis of a remote past and of expressing its cultural position, shows that the Trojan past functioned in the Roman context not only as a genealogical but also as a cultural language of representation (Gruen, 1993, p. 49). Zanker's assessment of the association, in the period of Caesar and Octavian, of the images of Venus and Aeneas with the divine and heroic ancestors of the Julian line explains the visual dimension of this ideological ground (Zanker, 1988, pp. 33, 201-202). Spawforth's assessment of the reorganisation of the Greek past within imperial culture in the Augustan period likewise supports this wider context (Spawforth, 2012, pp. 107-136). Parion did not occupy the central place held by Ilion in Rome's Troy-Aeneas imagination.

It would therefore not be correct to assess Parion and Ilion on the same plane. Ilion holds a special place in Rome's relationship with the Trojan past; the privileges Caesar granted Ilion clearly show this position (Erskine, 2001, p. 19). Parion's importance lies not in sharing this central function of Ilion but in the ability of a city not located at the centre of the epic and sacred geography of the Troad to rearticulate its own local memory repertoire within the Roman-period colonial idiom.

Roman imperial language cannot be explained merely as a one-directional propaganda system transmitted from centre to periphery. Ando's approach, according to which Roman political and visual forms could be used by provincial societies within a shared public language expressing local status, allegiance and belonging, provides a useful framework for understanding Parion's representational repertoire that carried its colonial status together with its local images (Ando, 2000, pp. 59-60, 84, 200). Price's assessment, that Roman power in Asia Minor could be reinterpreted by local communities within traditional religious and public forms, strengthens this context (Price, 1984, pp. 99-100, 232-233). Within this framework the Roman language on Parian coins should be assessed not as the disappearance of local memory but as the re-expression of local elements within Roman-period public forms of representation.

Parion's Roman-period identity can be traced in particular through colonial status and the related numismatic data. Keleş states that after Parion's passage under Roman rule it gained strategic importance in the context of the Mithridatic Wars; that the CGIP legend associated with the period of Caesar should be understood as Colonia Gemella Iulia Pariana, and the CGIHP legend seen from the period of Hadrian onwards as Colonia Gemella Iulia Hadriana Pariana (Keleş, 2011, p. 241). Ful too reports that in the period of Hadrian the CGIHP legend is seen on coins and on inscribed architrave blocks recovered from the theatre; this evidence shows that the colonial identity could be traced not only in the numismatic but also in the epigraphic and architectural context (Ful, 2021, p. 170). More broadly, Parion's urban development and architectural transformation in the first and second centuries AD provide the material setting in which this colonial language became publicly visible (Başaran & Yılmaz, 2021).

Kızılyalçın Oyarçin's study of the Roman provincial coins found in the Parion excavations provides limited but important data supporting the place of this colonial language among the excavation finds. According to

Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, of the 355 Roman provincial coins found at Parion between 2005 and 2020, 273 are Parion-minted; within the pseudo-autonomous group, of 43 coins 32 are Parion-minted, 24 of which date to the period of Julius Caesar (Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, 2023, pp. IV-V, 177-178). The same study notes that the reverse repertoire of the Parion-minted coins includes types associated with the Roman colonial titulature, such as the she-wolf (Lupa), Romulus and Remus, the Genius, the priest/colonist and the plough (Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, 2023, p. 177). These data show that in the Roman period Parion could strongly foreground its own name and colonial status through coin circulation; but on their own they do not prove the implementation of a specific centrally directed imperial programme. In this context the *Pario Conditori* type is important in showing the intersection between local foundational memory and the Roman colonial language. As noted in the fifth section, this type does not permit fixing the figure definitively as Parius or as Paris; its real importance is that the *conditor* language made founder-figure memory legible within the representational logic of the Roman period. The type thus shows, less than proving a single identity, that Parion could keep foundation memory in play among the local eponymous tradition, the epic association of the Troad and Roman colonial discourse.

The relationship between the Paris/Alexandros memory and Rome's Aeneas-centred Trojan ideology must also be assessed within this measured framework. Aeneas holds a special place for Rome as founding ancestor, model of *pietas* and legitimacy figure of the Julian line. Paris/Alexandros, by contrast, is in the Parian context not a historical founder but an epic figure gaining meaning within the naming traditions, the agora-centred order of commemoration and the representational repertoire. For this reason the Paris/Alexandros memory at Parion should be thought of not as a model opposed to, or replacing, the Aeneas ideology but as a different local reading of the Trojan past. The Roman period did not create this reading but allowed it to enter a wider environment of representation within its colonial idiom and imperial visual codes.

This synthesis also limits explaining Parion's strategy of identity through a one-directional model of "Romanisation". The city's public representation in the Roman period points not to the loss of local identity, but to the re-expression of local elements through Roman status language. The sacred heritage from Adrasteia, the Apollo Aktaios and altar images, the Eros/Cupid tradition, the public memory concerning Paris/Alexandros and the *Pario Conditori* type are not evidence at the same level; but assessed together they show that Parion could reorganise its past through different channels of representation.

In conclusion, Parion's Roman-period identity was neither that of a central locus of Rome-Troy ideology, as in the case of Ilion, nor that of a simple colonial identity detached from local memory. Parion's distinctive position lies in the ability of a city remaining outside the epic centre of the Troad to represent selectively, within the Roman colonial language, its local sacred heritage, its epic associations, and its art and cult references. Taken together, the Roman-period evidence indicates that Parion's local memory was rearticulated through colonial status and imperial visual codes.

Conclusion

This article has approached Parion's place in the epic and sacred geography of the Troad through a differentiated repertoire of memory and representation whose components were reused and recontextualised in different periods. Its position outside the centre of the Homeric narrative provided a context in which civic identity could operate through naming traditions, local sacred-genealogical narratives, the Adrasteia legacy, agora-centred commemoration and numismatic images. The relevant bodies of evidence do not carry equal evidentiary weight. Colonisation traditions and the Parios/Iasion eponymy concern naming and origin memory; the Ophiogeneis tradition belongs to a local sacred-genealogical repertoire; and the Paris/Priamos-Amandros narratives document later associations with the epic memory of the Troad. Strabo's account of Adrasteia, Apollo Aktaios and Artemis provides the principal textual basis for discussing the reported transport of sanctuary material and its association with the Altar of Hermokreon at Parion (Strab. 13.1.13 = Frisch, 1983, p. 90, no. T102a). Athenagoras' reference to a *taphos*, bronze *eikōn*, sacrifice and festival for Alexandros offers a specific textual record of public and ritual commemoration in the agora, although the figure's identity remains contested (Ath. Leg. 26.3-5 = Frisch, 1983, p. 58, no. T41).

The numismatic repertoire forms the material and visual dimension, in public circulation, of this commemorative order. The series extending from the early Gorgoneion and bull types to the Apollo Aktaios,

altar, Eros/Cupid and *Pario Conditori* types brings together in the same visual field different references, from Parion's early civic recognisability to the sacred references connected with Adrasteia, to artistic memory and to the Roman colonial language. These types do not on their own represent ritual practice or an integral political programme; but they are important in showing which figures, images and sacred-founding references Parion could carry into public representation.

The Roman period did not create this field of identity *ex nihilo*; rather, it provided a new representational ground on which local, sacred and epic memory elements could be re-expressed through colonial status, Latin legends and imperial visual codes. For this reason, Parion did not occupy the central position held by Ilion in Rome's relationship with the Trojan past; this, however, does not diminish the city's importance. Parion's distinctiveness lies in the ability of a city remaining outside the epic centre of the Troad to relate, within the same field of civic memory, its immediate sacred heritage, its local genealogical narratives, its agora memory, its art and cult references, and the Roman-period colonial language.

The value of the Parion case lies in bringing uneven bodies of evidence into a single analytical frame without flattening their differences. Ancient testimony, late mythographic transmission, local sacred genealogy, monumental memory and coin imagery operate at different levels. Within that frame, selected elements of Parion's past became usable through names, genealogies, sacred heritage, public space, monuments and circulating images. The case therefore supports a limited but methodologically important conclusion: Parion's civic identity took shape through the selective and recontextualised combination of memory elements belonging to different periods and supported by evidence of unequal weight.

Ethics Committee Approval: Ethics committee approval is not required.
Peer-review: Externally peer-reviewed.
Conflict of Interest: The authors have no conflicts of interest to declare.
Financial Disclosure: The authors declared that this study has no financial support.

References

Ancient Sources

Athenagoras. (1972). *Legatio and De resurrectione* (W. R. Schoedel, Ed. & Trans.). Clarendon Press.

Athenagoras. (1990). *Legatio pro Christianis* (M. Marcovich, Ed.). Walter de Gruyter.

Pliny the Elder. (1961). *Natural history: Volume IX, Books 33-35* (H. Rackham, Trans.; Loeb Classical Library). Harvard University Press; William Heinemann.

Strabo. (1960). *The geography of Strabo* (Vol. 6, Books 13-14; H. L. Jones, Trans.; Loeb Classical Library). Harvard University Press; William Heinemann.

Modern Literatures

Alcock, S. E. (2002). *Archaeologies of the Greek past: Landscape, monuments, and memory*. Cambridge University Press.

Ando, C. (2000). *Imperial ideology and provincial loyalty in the Roman Empire*. University of California Press.

Assmann, J. (2011). *Cultural memory and early civilization: Writing, remembrance, and political imagination*. Cambridge University Press.

Avram, A. (2004). The Propontic coast of Asia Minor. In M. H. Hansen & T. H. Nielsen (Eds.), *An inventory of archaic and classical poleis: An investigation conducted by The Copenhagen Polis Centre for the Danish National Research Foundation* (pp. 974–999). Oxford University Press.

Başaran, C., & Yılmaz, A. (2021). Parion'un (Parium) MS 1.–2. Yüzyıl Kentsel Gelişimi ve Mimarisi Hakkında Ön Değerlendirme. In M. A. Yılmaz, B. Can, & M. Işıklı (Eds.), *Anadolu Arkeolojisiyle Harmanlanmış Bir Ömür: Mehmet Karaosmanoğlu'na Armağan* (pp. 107–133). Bilgin Kültür Sanat Yayınları.

Cook, J. M. (1973). *The Troad: An archaeological and topographical study*. Clarendon Press.

Corso, A. (2020). The bronze statue of Paris by Euphranor. In A. Delivorrias, E. Vikela, A. Zarkadas, N. Kaltsas, & I. Trianti (Eds.), *Spondē: Aphierōma stē mnēmē tou Giōrgou Despinē [Σπονδή: Αφιέρωμα στη μνήμη του Γιώργου Δεσπίνη]* (Vol. A, pp. 355–360). Benaki Museum.

Curty, O. (1999). La parenté légendaire à l'époque hellénistique. *Kernos, 12*, 167–194. https://doi.org/10.4000/kernos.711

de Polignac, F. (1995). *Cults, territory, and the origins of the Greek city-state* (J. Lloyd, Trans.). University of Chicago Press.

Dickenson, C. P. (2017). *On the agora: The evolution of a public space in Hellenistic and Roman Greece (c. 323 BC–267 AD)*. Brill.

Ekroth, G. (2002). *The sacrificial rituals of Greek hero-cults in the Archaic to the early Hellenistic periods* (Kernos Supplément 12). Centre International d'Étude de la Religion Grecque Antique.

Erpehlivan, H. (2019). Arkaik ve Klasik Dönem'de Propontis çevresindeki kültler ve kutsal alanlar. *MSGSÜ Sosyal Bilimler, 3*(19), 35–57. https://dergipark.org.tr/tr/pub/msgsusbd/article/1104806

Erskine, A. (2001). *Troy between Greece and Rome: Local tradition and imperial power*. Oxford University Press.

Frisch, P. (1983). *Die Inschriften von Parion* (Inschriften griechischer Städte aus Kleinasien, Band 25). Dr. Rudolf Habelt.

Ful, Ş. D. (2021). Yazılı kaynaklar ışığında Parion'da tapınım gören kültler. *Sosyal Bilimler Araştırmaları Dergisi, 16*(2), 163–180. https://doi.org/10.48145/gopsbad.1005074

Gruen, E. S. (1993). *Culture and national identity in Republican Rome*. Duckworth.

Jones, C. P. (2010). *New heroes in antiquity: From Achilles to Antinoos*. Harvard University Press.

Keleş, V. (2011). Parion history from coins. In N. Holmes (Ed.), *Proceedings of the XIVth International Numismatic Congress: Glasgow 2009* (Vol. 1, pp. 237–245). Gutenberg Press.

Keleş, V. (2018). Some observations on the altar of Hermokreon in Parion. In D. Katsonopoulou (Ed.), *Paros IV: Paros and its colonies: Proceedings of the Fourth International Conference on the Archaeology of Paros and the Cyclades, Paroikia, Paros, 11–14 June 2015* (pp. 24–31). The Institute for Archaeology of Paros and the Cyclades.

Keleş, V., & Yılmaz, M. D. (2021). Statues of Parion: Evidence from ancient sources. In D. Katsonopoulou (Ed.), *Paros V: Paros through the ages from prehistoric times to the 16th century AD: Proceedings of the Fifth International Conference on the Archaeology of Paros and the Cyclades, Paroikia, Paros, 21–24 June 2019* (pp. 381–391). The Institute for Archaeology of Paros and the Cyclades.

Kızılyalçın Oyarçin, F. (2023). *Parion kazılarında bulunan Roma Eyalet sikkeleri* [Unpublished doctoral dissertation, Atatürk Üniversitesi Sosyal Bilimler Enstitüsü].

Körpe, R. (2014). Kuzey Troas'ta bir ova: Adrasteia Ovası Eskiçağ tarihi ve arkeolojisi. *KUBABA Arkeoloji-Sanat Tarihi-Tarih Dergisi, 23*, 7–16.

Kraft, K. (1957). *Sylloge Nummorum Graecorum: Deutschland. Sammlung v. Aulock: Heft 4. Mysien*. Gebr. Mann.

Leaf, W. (1923). *Strabo on the Troad*. Cambridge University Press.

Malkin, I. (2011). *A small Greek world: Networks in the ancient Mediterranean*. Oxford University Press.

Nora, P. (1989). Between memory and history: Les lieux de mémoire. *Representations, 26*, 7–24.

Özmen, S. (2024). *Parion Antik Kenti teritoryumu* [Unpublished doctoral dissertation, Atatürk Üniversitesi Sosyal Bilimler Enstitüsü].

Palagia, O. (1980). *Euphranor*. E. J. Brill.

Price, S. R. F. (1984). *Rituals and power: The Roman imperial cult in Asia Minor*. Cambridge University Press.

RPC Online. (n.d.). *Roman Provincial Coinage Online*. Ashmolean Museum, University of Oxford. https://rpc.ashmus.ox.ac.uk/

Schreyer, J. (2023). Unsichtbar präsent: Der Monumentalaltar des Hermokreon in Parion und seine Inszenierung als wiederverwertetes Heiligtum. *Istanbuler Mitteilungen, 73*, 84–97. https://doi.org/10.34780/dy0e-fd53

Spawforth, A. J. S. (2012). *Greece and the Augustan cultural revolution*. Cambridge University Press.

Wroth, W. (1892). *Catalogue of the Greek coins of Mysia* (R. S. Poole, Ed.). The Trustees of the British Museum.

Zanker, P. (1988). *The power of images in the age of Augustus* (A. Shapiro, Trans.). University of Michigan Press.

Figures



Fig. 1: The Adrasteia-Parion sacred landscape. The localisation of Adrasteia is shown approximately, following the assessments of Leaf, Körpe and Özmen; the precise location and boundaries of the settlement remain disputed.



Fig. 2: Parian coin types: (a–b) bull/Gorgoneion AR hemidrachm, fourth century BC; (c–d) Demeter/Apollo Aktaios AR tetradrachm, c. 133–50 BC. Credits: (a–b) Nomos AG, obolos 41, lot 170; (c–d) Münzkabinett Berlin, inv. 18257344, photo Bernhard Weisser, Public Domain Mark 1.0.



Fig. 3: Roman-period Parian coin types: (a–b) Severus Alexander, Eros beside a herm, Cat. 241 (BBI296); (c–d) youthful male head with PARIO CONDIT and she-wolf with twins, Cat. 102 (CKS001). Photos: Parion Excavation Archive.